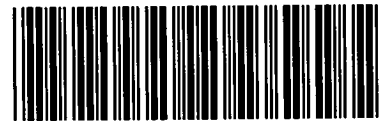


Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited

**Annual report and financial statements
for the year ended 31 August 2024**

Company number 11524091

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Company Information

Directors	PJ Cardosi GA Cook (appointed 5 September 2024) JAW Gooze Zijl (appointed 28 May 2025) CP Kroeger (appointed 5 September 2024) RJ Surridge JC Paton (appointed 5 September 2024; resigned 30 June 2025)
Company number	11524091
Registered office	60 Gresham Street London EC2V 7BB United Kingdom
Independent auditor	Beaumont Seymour Limited 47 Butt Road Colchester Essex CO3 3BZ United Kingdom

Strategic report

The Directors present their strategic report for the year ended 31 August 2024.

Business review

The principal activity of the Group is the supply of consultancy resources and project management services, primarily to the financial services, asset management and security services sectors. The Group's revenue is generated through the sale of consultancy and project support services to these industries and supplying workers on long term contracts to support our clients in implementing and completing those projects.

During the year, the Group generated turnover of £16,458,344 (2023: £17,011,413). Despite the reduction in revenue, the Group successfully retained key client relationships and maintained a diversified client base. Gross profit margin improved to 13.8% (2023: 12.4%), reflecting the progression of several major projects into the implementation stage of the client delivery cycle.

At 31 August 2024, the Group reported net liabilities of £2,054 (2023: net assets of £13,649). Debtors of £1,696,344 (2023: £1,609,370) together with cash balances of £247,691 (2023: £999,709) were broadly matched by creditors of £1,946,089 (2023: £2,595,430). The Directors consider the Group to have sufficient resources to meet its short-term obligations and remain confident in its ability to continue to trade for the foreseeable future.

The average number of employees during the year was 78 (2023: 86).

Key performance indicators

The Directors monitor performance on a monthly basis using a range of financial and non-financial metrics. Working capital management is a key indicator which is reviewed on a frequent basis to monitor cash flow, liquidity and the recovery of trade receivables.

Each month the Directors review the management accounts and compare actual performance against budget. Costs, utilisation, and fee rates are also reviewed to monitor profitability.

Principal risks and uncertainties

The principal risks and uncertainties faced by the Company are outlined below:

- **Competitors** – risk that a competitor or new entrant may be able to achieve success and win work from the Company's existing clients. Less mature or more specialist propositions, which the Company chooses to develop, may present less of a competitive advantage.
- **Macro** – risk that wider market, economic, commercial and financial risks can impact the Company's ability to service clients, their demand for consultancy and technology services and, therefore, the Company's own performance and financial position.
- **Quality of service** – risk of failure to maintain quality of service on client delivery engagements.
- **People** – risk of failure to attract, incentivise and retain the best people with the right capabilities across all propositions, levels and geographies. A failure to undertake effective succession planning for key roles could also adversely increase this risk and impact performance.

Strategic report (continued)

- **Business strategy** – risk that the Company responds inadequately to changing market factors, including technological advancements, and strategic growth opportunities, including acquisitions. The success of the Company depends on continuing to develop a proposition that best serves its clients.
- **Security** – risk of cyber-attacks, security breaches and data mishandling, leading to consequent risks to client data, loss of integrity or availability of core data.

In addition to the principal risks disclosed above, the Group is also exposed to other risks that are not considered principal risks. These include geopolitical, technological, regulatory, and financial risks.

Future developments

The Directors have worked hard during the year to deepen their relationships with aligned organisations in the sector and are confident that the Group will see growth through its partnerships. The Group will also continue to diversify into the insurance sector where there is a strong appetite for its services.

After the year end, the Group was acquired by Alpha Financial Markets Consulting UK Limited, a leading global consultancy to the financial services industry. The Directors are excited about this opportunity to bring together Bankside's depth of delivery expertise, with the breadth of experience and capability that the Alpha team has to offer. The Directors are confident of future growth through this partnership.

This report was approved by the board of Directors and signed on its behalf by:



RJ Surridge
Director
9 September 2025

Directors' report

The Directors present their report and the consolidated financial statements for the year ended 31 August 2024.

Principal activity

The principal activity of the Group is the supply of consultancy resources and project management services, primarily to the financial services, asset management and security services sectors.

Results and dividend

The results for the year are set out in the strategic report on page 2. The Directors consider the current state of affairs of the Company to be satisfactory.

Directors

The Directors who held office during the year and up to the date of approval of this report are as follows:

PJ Cardosi

GA Cook (appointed 5 September 2024)

JAW Gooze Zijl (appointed 28 May 2025)

CP Kroeger (appointed 5 September 2024)

RJ Surridge

JC Paton (appointed 5 September 2024; resigned 30 June 2025)

Political contributions

The Company made no political donations and incurred no political expenditure during the year (2023: £NIL).

Employees

Attracting, retaining and developing the best talent is essential to the Company's business success. The Company is committed to providing a highly rewarding workplace, and to maintaining a strong, meritocratic and inclusive culture that recognises the importance of our people and encourages open communication.

The Company is committed to ensuring equality of opportunity for all employees and applicants. Full and fair consideration is given to all applications of employment from disabled persons. Appropriate arrangements are made for all disabled person, including those who have become disabled during their employment. The Group is committed to the training and development of disabled persons and ensuring they have the access to the same opportunities as other employees.

Engagement with suppliers and customers

The Directors note the importance of fostering strong relationships with customers and suppliers through open communication and having regard for these relationships in strategic decisions made relating to the Company.

Directors' report (continued)

Disclosure of information to auditor

Each of the persons who are Directors as at the date of approval of this report confirms that:

- So far as the Director is aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the Company's auditors are unaware; and
- The Director has taken all the steps that they ought to have taken as a Director in order to make themselves aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the Company's auditors are aware of that information.

This report was approved by the board of Directors and signed on its behalf by:



RJ Surridge
Director
9 September 2025

Statement of Directors' responsibilities

The Directors are responsible for preparing the strategic report, the Directors' report and the Group and parent Company financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations.

Company law requires the Directors to prepare Group and parent company financial statements for each financial year. Under that law they have elected to prepare the financial statements in accordance with UK accounting standards and applicable law (UK Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

Under company law the Directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the Group and parent company and of the Group's profit or loss for that period. In preparing each of the Group and parent company financial statements, the Directors are required to:

- Select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;
- Make judgements and estimates that are reasonable, relevant, and reliable and prudent;
- State whether applicable UK accounting standards have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements;
- Assess the Company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern; and
- Use the going concern basis of accounting unless they either intend to liquidate the Company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

The Directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the parent Company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the parent Company and enable them to ensure that its financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They are responsible for such internal control as they determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and have general responsibility for taking such steps as are reasonably open to them to safeguard the assets of the Group and to prevent and detect fraud and other irregularities.

BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED
GROUP FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

TO THE MEMBERS OF BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited (the 'parent company') and its subsidiaries (the 'group') for the year ended 31 August 2024 which comprise the group profit and loss account, the group statement of comprehensive income, the group balance sheet, the company balance sheet, the group statement of changes in equity, the company statement of changes in equity, the group statement of cash flows and notes to the financial statements, including significant accounting policies. The financial reporting framework that has been applied in their preparation is applicable law and United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including FRS 102, *The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland* (United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

In our opinion the financial statements:

- give a true and fair view of the state of the group's and the parent company's affairs as at 31 August 2024 and of the group's profit for the year then ended;
- have been properly prepared in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice; and
- have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) (ISAs (UK)) and applicable law. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements* section of our report. We are independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, including the FRC's Ethical Standard, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the group's and parent company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Other information

The other information comprises the information included in the annual report other than the financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information contained within the annual report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in our report, we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon. Our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the course of the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, we are required to determine whether this gives rise to a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact.

We have nothing to report in this regard.

Opinions on other matters prescribed by the Companies Act 2006

In our opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of our audit:

- the information given in the strategic report and the directors' report for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements; and
- the strategic report and the directors' report have been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED
GROUP FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT (CONTINUED)
TO THE MEMBERS OF BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED

Matters on which we are required to report by exception

In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the group and the parent company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we have not identified material misstatements in the strategic report and the directors' report.

We have nothing to report in respect of the following matters where the Companies Act 2006 requires us to report to you if, in our opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept by the parent company, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- the parent company financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of directors' remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit.

Responsibilities of directors

As explained more fully in the directors' responsibilities statement, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error. In preparing the financial statements, the directors are responsible for assessing the parent company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Irregularities, including fraud, are instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. We design procedures in line with our responsibilities, outlined above, to detect material misstatements in respect of irregularities, including fraud. The extent to which our procedures are capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud, is detailed below.

BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED
GROUP FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT (CONTINUED)
TO THE MEMBERS OF BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED

Detection of Irregularities, including fraud

The objectives of our audit in respect of fraud, are; to identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements due to fraud; to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the assessed risks of material misstatement due to fraud, through designing and implementing appropriate responses to those assessed risks; and to respond appropriately to instances of fraud or suspected fraud identified during the audit. However, the primary responsibility for the prevention and detection of fraud rests with both management and those charged with governance of the company.

Our approach was as follows:

- We obtained an understanding of the legal and regulatory requirements applicable to the company and determined that the most significant laws and regulations which are directly relevant to specific assertions in the financial statements are those related to the financial reporting framework (Companies Act 2006, UK GAAP) and UK taxation legislation.
- We obtained an understanding of how the company complies with these requirements by discussions with management and those charged with governance.
- We assessed the risk of material misstatement of the financial statements, including the risk of material misstatement due to fraud and how it might occur by holding discussions with management and those charged with governance.
- We inquired of management and those charged with governance as to any known instances of non-compliance or suspected non-compliance with laws and regulations.
- Based on this understanding, we designed specific appropriate audit procedures to identify instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. This included making enquiries of management and those charged with governance and obtaining additional corroborative evidence as required.

As part of an audit in accordance with ISAs (UK) we exercise professional judgement and maintain professional scepticism throughout the audit.

We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purposes of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the company's internal control.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by the directors.
- Conclude on the appropriateness of the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting and, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the related disclosures in the financial statements or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the company to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the financial statements, including the disclosures, and whether the financial statements
- represent the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.
- Obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the financial information of the entities or business activities within the company to express an opinion on the consolidated financial statements. We are responsible for the direction, supervision and performance of the company audit. We remain solely responsible for our audit opinion.

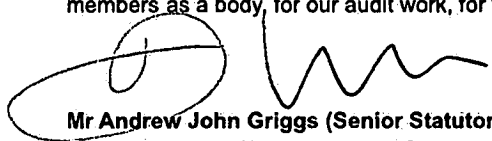
We communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

**BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED
GROUP FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT (CONTINUED)
TO THE MEMBERS OF BANKSIDE FINANCIAL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING LIMITED**

A further description of our responsibilities is available on the Financial Reporting Council's website at: <https://www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities>. This description forms part of our auditor's report.

Use of our report

This report is made solely to the company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an auditor's report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the company and the company's members as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.



Mr Andrew John Griggs (Senior Statutory Auditor)
For and on behalf of Beaumont Seymour

Date: 10/3/25

**Chartered Certified Accountants
Statutory Auditor**

47 Butt Road
Colchester
Essex
CO3 3BZ

Consolidated statement of comprehensive income
for the year ended 31 August 2024

	Note	2024 £	2023 £
Turnover	3	16,458,344	17,011,413
Cost of sales		(14,186,428)	(14,903,536)
Gross profit		2,271,916	2,107,877
Administration expenses		(2,284,186)	(2,082,511)
Operating (loss)/profit		(12,270)	25,366
Finance income	5	24	23
Finance expense	6	-	(2,129)
(Loss)/profit before tax		(12,246)	23,260
Taxation	9	(3,457)	(23,393)
Loss for the year		(15,703)	(133)

There was no other comprehensive income for 2024 (2023: £NIL).

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

Consolidated balance sheet
as at 31 August 2024

	Note	2024 £	2023 £
Current assets			
Debtors	11	1,696,344	1,609,370
Cash at bank and in hand		247,691	999,709
		1,944,035	2,609,079
Creditors: Amounts falling due within one year	13	(1,946,089)	(2,595,430)
Net (liabilities)/assets		(2,054)	13,649
Capital and reserves			
Called up share capital	15	100	100
Retained earnings		(2,154)	13,549
Equity attributable to owners of the Company		(2,054)	13,649
Shareholders' equity		(2,054)	13,649

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

These financial statements were approved by the board of Directors and signed on its behalf by:



RJ Surridge
Director
9 September 2025

Company balance sheet
as at 31 August 2024

	Note	2024 £	2023 £
Fixed assets			
Investments	10	1,162	1,162
Current assets			
Debtors	11	1,702,504	1,576,439
Cash at bank and in hand		191,067	900,550
		1,893,571	2,476,989
Creditors: Amounts falling due within one year	13	(1,884,669)	(2,456,465)
Net current assets		8,902	20,524
Net assets		10,064	21,686
Capital and reserves			
Called up share capital	15	100	100
Retained earnings		9,964	21,586
Shareholders' equity		10,064	21,686

As permitted by Section 408 of the Companies Act 2006, a separate income statement for the Company has not been presented. The Company made a loss after tax for the financial year of £11,622 (2023: profit of £7,904).

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

These financial statements were approved by the board of Directors and signed on its behalf by:



RJ Surridge
Director
9 September 2025

Consolidated statement of changes in equity
for the year ended 31 August 2024

	Called up share capital £	Retained earnings £	Total shareholders' equity £
As at 1 September 2023	100	13,549	13,649
Loss for the year	-	(15,703)	(15,703)
As at 31 August 2024	100	(2,154)	(2,054)

	Called up share capital £	Retained earnings £	Total shareholders' equity £
As at 1 September 2022	100	13,682	13,782
Loss for the year	-	(133)	(133)
As at 31 August 2023	100	13,549	13,649

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

Company statement of changes in equity
for the year ended 31 August 2024

	Called up share capital £	Retained earnings £	Total shareholders' equity £
As at 1 September 2023	100	21,586	21,686
Loss for the year	-	(11,622)	(11,622)
As at 31 August 2024	100	9,964	10,064

	Called up share capital £	Retained earnings £	Total shareholders' equity £
As at 1 September 2022	100	13,682	13,782
Profit for the year	-	7,904	7,904
As at 31 August 2023	100	21,586	21,686

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

Consolidated cash flow statement
for the year ended 31 August 2024

	Note	2024 £	2023 £
Cash flows from operating activities:			
Loss for the year		(15,703)	(133)
Adjustments to cash flows for non-cash items:			
Finance income	5	(24)	(23)
Income tax expense	9	3,457	23,393
Working capital adjustments:			
Increase in debtors	11	(95,828)	(78,533)
(Decrease)/increase in creditors	13	(643,944)	758,938
Cash (used in)/generated from operations		(752,042)	703,642
Income taxes paid	9	-	(4,164)
Net cash (used in)/generated from operating activities		(752,042)	699,478
Cash flows from investing activities:			
Interest received		24	23
Net (decrease)/increase in cash and cash equivalents		(752,018)	699,501
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the period		999,709	300,208
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the period		247,691	999,709

The Company is a qualifying entity for the purposes of FRS 102 and has elected to take the exemption under paragraph 1.12(b) of FRS 102 not to present the Company cash flow statement.

The notes on pages 17 to 25 form an integral part of these financial statements.

Notes to the financial statements

1. General information

Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited is a private company, limited by shares, incorporated in England and Wales with the registered number 11524091. Its registered office is 60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB, United Kingdom. The nature of the Group's operations and its principal activities are set out in the strategic report.

2. Accounting policies

Summary of significant accounting policies and key accounting estimates

The principal accounting policies applied in the preparation of these financial statements are set out below. These policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

Statement of compliance

The consolidated and Company financial statements were prepared in accordance with Financial Reporting Standard 102 'The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the United Kingdom and Republic of Ireland and the Companies Act 2006'.

Basis of preparation

These consolidated and individual financial statements have been prepared using the historical cost convention except that as disclosed in the accounting policies certain items are shown at fair value.

Financial Reporting Standard 102 – reduced disclosure exemptions

The following exemptions available under FRS 102 have been taken in respect of Company only disclosures, as the consolidated financial statements contain equivalent disclosures:

- the requirements of Section 7 Statement of Cash Flows;
- the requirements of Section 3 Financial Statement Presentation paragraph 3.17(d);
- the requirements of Section 11 Financial Instruments paragraphs 11.42, 11.44 to 11.45, 11.47, 11.48(a)(iii), 11.48(a)(iv), 11.48(b) and 11.48(c);
- the requirements of Section 12 Other Financial Instruments paragraphs 12.26 to 12.27, 12.29(a), 12.29(b) and 12.29A;
- the requirements of Section 26 Share-based Payment paragraphs 26.18(b), 26.19 to 26.21 and 26.23;
- the requirements of Section 29 Income tax paragraphs 29.28(b) and 29.29. This is an exemption from certain disclosures in relation to Pillar Two model rules where an entity is, or expects to be, within the scope of the Pillar Two legislation. The exemption is dependent on equivalent disclosures being made in the consolidated financial statements. It is not an exemption from all Pillar Two model rules and disclosures. Qualifying entities are still required to provide disclosures in accordance with paragraph 29.26 (g) and 29.28(a) if Pillar two model rules are applicable;
- the requirements of Section 33 Related Party Disclosures paragraph 33.7.

Basis of consolidation

The consolidated financial statements consolidate the financial statements of the company and its subsidiary undertakings drawn up to 31 August 2024.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

A subsidiary is an entity controlled by the company. Control is achieved where the company has the power to govern the financial and operating policies of an entity so as to obtain benefits from its activities.

The results of subsidiaries acquired or disposed of during the year are included in the Profit and Loss Account from the effective date of acquisition or up to the effective date of disposal, as appropriate. Where necessary, adjustments are made to the financial statements of subsidiaries to bring their accounting policies into line with those used by the group.

Inter-company transactions, balances and unrealised gains on transactions between the company and its subsidiaries, which are related parties, are eliminated in full.

Going concern

The consolidated and Company financial statements have been prepared on a going concern basis. The directors have considered the Group's financial position, cash flow forecasts and future funding requirements, together with the principal risks and uncertainties facing the business. On the basis of this review, the directors have a reasonable expectation that the Group and the Company have adequate resources to continue in operational existence for the foreseeable future.

Turnover

Turnover comprises the fair value of the consideration received or receivable for the sale of goods and provision of services in the ordinary course of the group's activities. Turnover is shown net of sales/value added tax, returns, rebates and discounts and after eliminating sales within the Group. The Group recognises revenue when:

- the amount of revenue can be reliably measured;
- it is probable that future economic benefits will flow to the entity; and
- specific criteria have been met for each of the group's activities.

Foreign currency transactions

Transactions in foreign currencies are translated to the relevant entity's functional currency at the average foreign exchange rate in the month of the transaction. Monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies at the balance sheet date are retranslated to the functional currency of the relevant entity at the foreign exchange rate ruling at that date. Non-monetary assets and liabilities that are measured in terms of historical cost in a foreign currency are translated using the exchange rate at the date of the transaction and are not retranslated. Foreign exchange gains and losses arising on the retranslation of monetary assets and liabilities into functional currency are recognised in administration expenses.

The revenue and expenses of foreign operations are translated to the Group's presentational currency, pound sterling, at the average foreign exchange rate in the month of the date of the transactions. The assets and liabilities of foreign operations are translated to the Group's presentational currency at foreign exchange rates ruling at the balance sheet date. Foreign exchange gains and losses arising on retranslation of assets and liabilities to the Group's presentational currency are recognised in other comprehensive income. These gains and losses may be reclassified subsequently to profit or loss if certain conditions are met.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

Tax

Current tax is the amount of income tax payable in respect of the taxable profit for the year, using tax rates enacted or substantively enacted at the balance sheet date, and any adjustment to tax payable in respect of previous years. Current tax is recognised in profit or loss except to the extent that it relates to items recognised in other comprehensive income or directly in equity, in which case the related tax is recognised in the same place.

Deferred tax is recognised in respect of temporary differences between the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities in the financial statements and the corresponding tax bases used in the computation of taxable profit. Deferred tax liabilities are generally recognised for all taxable temporary differences, and deferred tax assets are recognised to the extent that it is probable that future taxable profits will be available against which deductible temporary differences can be utilised. Deferred tax is measured using the tax rates and laws that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the balance sheet date and are expected to apply when the related deferred tax asset is realised or the deferred tax liability is settled.

Investments

Investments in equity shares which are publicly traded or where the fair value can be measured reliably are initially measured at fair value, with changes in fair value recognised in profit or loss. Investments in equity shares which are not publicly traded and where fair value cannot be measured reliably are measured at cost less impairment.

Interest income on debt securities, where applicable, is recognised in income using the effective interest method. Dividends on equity securities are recognised in income when receivable.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents comprise cash on hand and call deposits, and other short-term highly liquid investments that are readily convertible to a known amount of cash and are subject to an insignificant risk of change in value.

Trade debtors

Trade debtors are amounts due from customers for merchandise sold or services performed in the ordinary course of business.

Trade debtors are recognised initially at the transaction price. They are subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less provision for impairment. A provision for the impairment of trade debtors is established when there is objective evidence that the group will not be able to collect all amounts due according to the original terms of the receivables.

Trade creditors

Trade creditors are obligations to pay for goods or services that have been acquired in the ordinary course of business from suppliers. Accounts payable are classified as current liabilities if the group does not have an unconditional right, at the end of the reporting period, to defer settlement of the creditor for at least twelve months after the reporting date. If there is an unconditional right to defer settlement for at least twelve months after the reporting date, they are presented as non-current liabilities.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

Trade creditors are recognised initially at the transaction price and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

Share capital

Ordinary shares are classified as equity. Equity instruments are measured at the fair value of the cash or other resources received or receivable, net of the direct costs of issuing the equity instruments. If payment is deferred and the time value of money is material, the initial measurement is on a present value basis.

Defined contribution pension plan

A defined contribution plan is a pension plan under which fixed contributions are paid into a pension fund and the group has no legal or constructive obligation to pay further contributions even if the fund does not hold sufficient assets to pay all employees the benefits relating to employee service in the current and prior periods.

Contributions to defined contribution plans are recognised as employee benefit expense when they are due. If contribution payments exceed the contribution due for service, the excess is recognised as a prepayment.

3. Turnover

The analysis of the Group's turnover for the year from continuing operations is as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
Provision of consultancy services	16,458,344	17,011,413
	16,458,344	17,011,413

The analysis of the Group's turnover for the year by market is as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
UK	15,857,266	16,988,290
Europe	431,700	-
Rest of the world	169,378	23,123
	16,458,344	17,011,413

4. Auditor's remuneration

Fees payable to the Company's auditor for the audit of the consolidated financial statements for the year ended 31 August 2024 were £9,400 (2023: £8,800).

Fees payable to the Company's auditor for the audit of the Company's subsidiaries were £5,400 (2023: £5,400).

The auditor did not provide any non-audit services to the Group in the current or prior year.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

5. Finance income

	2024 £	2023 £
Interest income on bank deposits	24	23
	24	23

6. Finance expense

	2024 £	2023 £
Foreign exchange gains and losses	-	2,129
	-	2,129

7. Staff costs

The aggregate payroll costs (including Directors' remuneration) for the Group were as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
Wages and salaries	12,940,364	13,540,146
Social security costs	1,426,790	1,532,297
Other short-term employee benefits	40,199	44,085
Pension costs, defined contribution scheme	1,150,856	1,083,178
Other employee expenses	-	11,399
	15,558,209	16,211,105

The average number of persons employed by the Group (including Directors) during the year, analysed by category, was as follows:

	2024 No.	2023 No.
Consulting staff	78	86
	78	86

8. Directors' remuneration

The total Directors' remuneration for the year was as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
Wages, salaries & short-term benefits	2,245,167	2,152,229
Contributions paid to money purchase schemes	13,333	40,000
	2,258,500	2,192,229

As at 31 August 2024, one Director (2023: one Director) was accruing retirement benefits under money purchase pension schemes.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

The highest paid Director received total remuneration of £254,838, (2023: £267,783), of which £NIL (2023: £40,000) related to contributions to money purchase pension schemes.

9. Taxation

Tax charge – Group

	2024 £	2023 £
Current tax – UK	(5,397)	23,393
Deferred tax – UK	8,854	-
	3,457	23,393

The tax on loss before tax for the year is higher than the standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25% (2023: higher than the standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 19%). The differences are reconciled below:

	2024 £	2023 £
(Loss)/profit before tax	(12,246)	23,260
Tax at the standard UK corporation tax rate of 25%	(3,062)	4,628
Tax effect of expenses not deductible for taxation	6,519	18,626
Effect of tax losses	-	139
Tax charge for the year	3,457	23,393

Deferred tax assets and liabilities – Group

	2024 £	2023 £
Deferred tax assets	13,100	21,954
	13,100	21,954

The deferred tax assets relate to temporary timing differences between pension contributions recognised in profit and loss and the tax relief received when those pension contributions were paid after the end of the financial year.

10. Investments

Investments in subsidiaries – Company

	2024 £	2023 £
Cost and carrying amount		
At 1 September 2023 and 31 August 2024	1,162	1,162

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

Information about related undertakings

In accordance with Section 409 of the Companies Act 2006, the following table sets out the subsidiary and associated undertakings in which the Group and the Company held an interest of 20% or more as at 31 August 2024. All entities are direct subsidiaries of the Company. The Group holds 100% of the issued ordinary share capital of each subsidiary undertaking.

Subsidiary undertaking	Registered address	Principal activity
Bankside Asia Pte. Ltd.	10, Anson Road, #22-02, International Plaza, 079903, Singapore	Dormant
Bankside Cloud Technology Ltd	60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB, United Kingdom	Dormant
Bankside Payroll Limited	60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB, United Kingdom	Administration

11. Debtors

	Note	Group		Company	
		2024 £	2023 £	2024 £	2023 £
Due within one year					
Trade debtors		1,643,498	126,724	1,643,498	111,480
Amounts owed by subsidiaries		-	-	19,315	7,876
Other debtors		100	1,081	100	101
Prepayments		8,146	14,320	8,091	14,319
Accrued income		31,500	1,445,291	31,500	1,442,663
Deferred tax assets	9	13,100	21,954	-	-
		1,696,344	1,609,370	1,702,504	1,576,439

12. Cash and cash equivalents

	Group		Company	
	2024 £	2023 £	2024 £	2023 £
Cash at bank	247,691	999,709	191,067	900,550
	247,691	999,709	191,067	900,550

13. Creditors

	Note	Group		Company	
		2024 £	2023 £	2024 £	2023 £
Due within one year					
Trade creditors		40,976	230,254	40,976	230,254
Amounts due to subsidiaries		-	-	1,000	1,000
Social security and other taxes		516,212	784,345	516,212	784,345
Other creditors		52,401	102,688	-	-
Accruals		1,296,550	1,432,796	1,299,631	1,417,473
Income tax liability	9	39,950	45,347	26,850	23,393
		1,946,089	2,595,430	1,884,669	2,456,465

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

14. Pension and other schemes

The Group operates a defined contribution pension scheme. The pension expense for the year represents contributions payable by the Group to the scheme and amounted to £1,150,856 (2023: £1,083,178).

15. Share capital

Allotted, called up and fully paid shares

	2024		2023	
	No.	£	No.	£
Ordinary shares of £0.01 each	10,000	100	10,000	100

16. Related party transactions

Key management personnel

The Group considers key management personnel, as defined in paragraph 33.6 of FRS 102, to be the Company's Directors.

During the year, two entities controlled by the Company's Directors were engaged by the Group to provide management services. Transactions with these entities and amounts owed at the year end were as follows:

	2024		2023	
	Expenses in the year £	Amounts due at year end £	Expenses in the year £	Amounts due at year end £
JOJR Ltd	953,537	65,000	885,221	178,000
Bearsmor Ltd	953,537	65,000	858,959	175,000
	1,907,074	130,000	1,744,180	353,000

Amounts due to related parties at the year end are included within accruals (see note 13).

The related party transactions disclosed above are identical for both the Company and the Group.

Transactions with subsidiary companies

Transactions between the Company and its subsidiaries have been eliminated on consolidation. Further, the Company has taken the exemption available under paragraph 33.1A of FRS 102 and has therefore not disclosed related party transactions with wholly owned subsidiaries.

17. Ultimate controlling party

As at 31 August 2024, the Company had no ultimate controlling party. This Company is the smallest and largest undertaking for which consolidated financial statements are prepared and publicly available.

Notes to the financial statements (continued)

18. Events after the reporting period

On 5 September 2024, the Company and its subsidiaries were acquired by Alpha Financial Markets Consulting UK Limited, which is a wholly owned indirect subsidiary of Actium Topco (UK) Limited, a company owned by certain funds managed by Bridgepoint Advisers Limited.